UNIT 2 – STORY TELLING

1. Storytelling Techniques in Video Editing

Storytelling in video production means presenting events, characters, and emotions in a clear and interesting way so that the audience can understand and feel the story.

Editing plays a major role in storytelling because it decides:

- what shots are shown,
- in what order,
- for how long,
- and how scenes move from one to another.

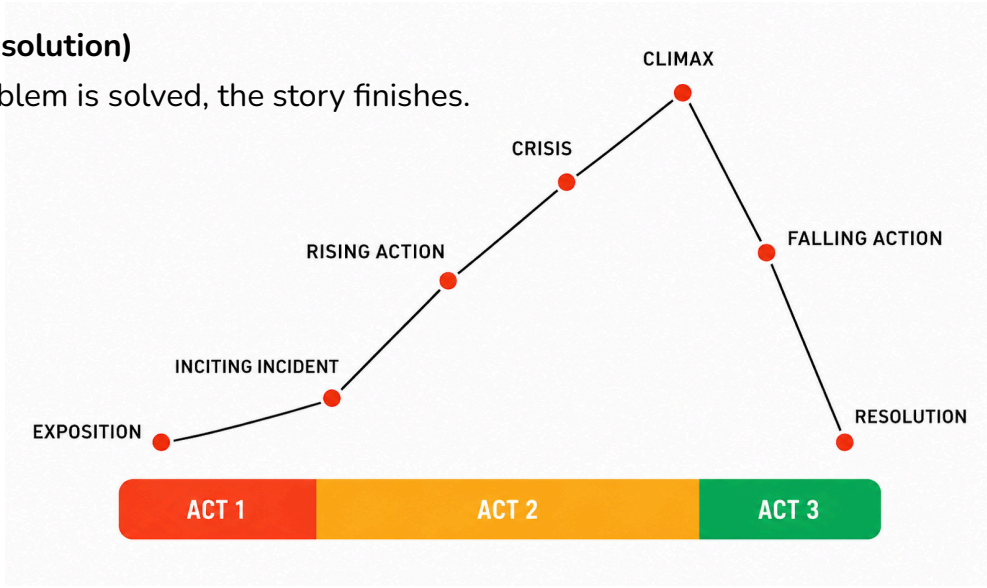
Good storytelling techniques make a video engaging, logical, emotional, and memorable.

1. Narrative Structure

Most videos follow a simple three-part structure.

Parts

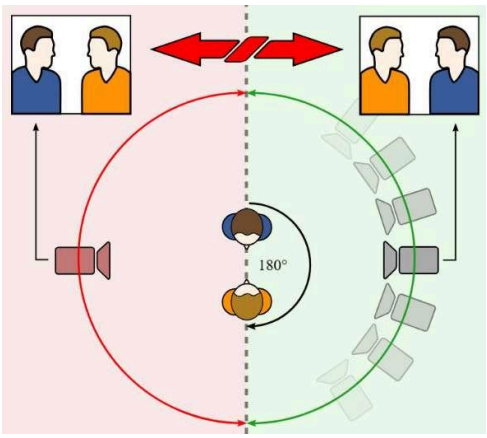
- **Beginning (Setup)**
  Introduces characters, place, and problem.
- **Middle (Conflict/Development)**
  Events grow, tension increases, and the story moves forward.
- **End (Resolution)**
  The problem is solved, the story finishes.



2. Continuity Editing

Continuity editing means arranging shots so that the action looks smooth and natural, without confusing the viewer.

- Maintain screen direction.
- Keep consistent lighting and costume.
- Match actions between shots.
- Follow the 180-degree rule.
- Makes scenes Realistic



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3. Use of Different Shot Types

Different camera shots help tell the story emotionally.

Common Shots

- **Wide shot** – shows place and environment.
- **Medium shot** – shows interaction.
- **Close-up** – shows emotions.
- **Over-the-shoulder** – shows conversations.
- **Cutaway** – shows related detail.

4. Pacing and Rhythm

Pacing means how fast or slow a scene moves.

1. **Fast Pacing**
    - Short shots C Quick cuts.
    - Used in action scene
2. **Slow Pacing**
    - Long shots.
    - Fewer cuts.
    - Used in emotional or dramatic scenes.

Example:

Avengers: Endgame uses fast pacing in battle scenes.

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5. Montage Technique

A montage is a series of short shots edited together to show:

- Passage of time
- Training
- Travel
- Repeated actions

Example: Training scenes in Rocky.

6. Sound as a Storytelling Tool

Sound strongly supports visuals.

Types

- Dialogue
- Background music
- Sound effects
- Silence

Uses

- Set the mood.
- Creates tension.
- Shows location.
- Connected scenes.
- Makes emotions stronger.

Storytelling techniques in video editing help make videos clear, emotional, and interesting. Good use of structure, shots, pacing, montage, and sound makes the story memorable and effective.

2. Storyboard in Digital Video Editing

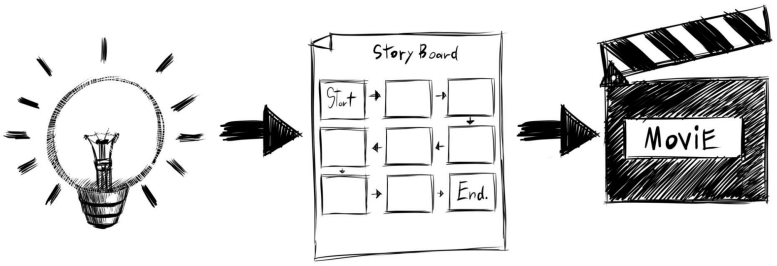
A storyboard is a visual plan used before shooting and editing a video. It contains a series of drawings or frames that show how each shot will look on screen. It helps directors and editors understand the story clearly.

What is a Storyboard?

A storyboard is like a comic strip of a video. Each frame shows one shot.

Each frame contains:

- Simple drawing of the shot
- Camera angle or movement
- Dialogue or narration
- Sound effects or music
- Shot timing
- Transition to next shot



It shows the full plan before shooting starts.

Importance of Storyboard in Digital Editing

- Helps imagine final video
- Guides camera team during shooting
- Makes editing easier
- Avoids unwanted shots
- Saves time and money
- Improves teamwork
- Keeps production organized

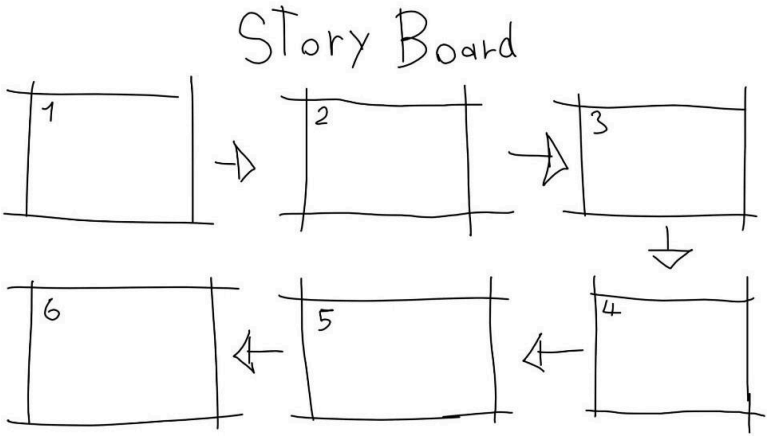
Example:

Action scenes in movies are planned first using storyboards.

Types of Storyboards

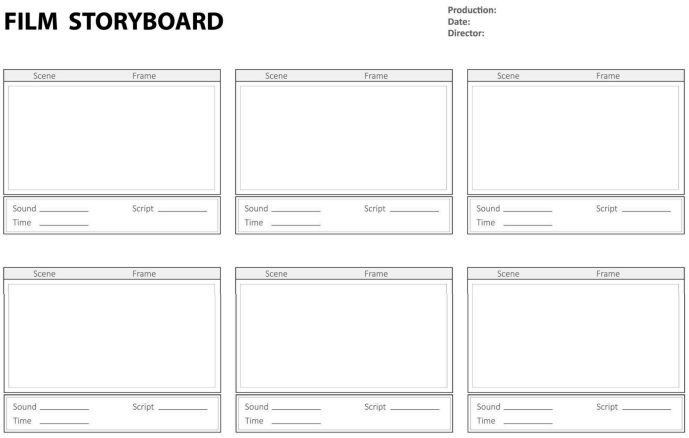
1. Hand-Drawn Storyboard

- Drawn on paper
- Used in small projects
- Easy and low cost



2. Digital Storyboard

- Made using software or tablet
- Easy to edit and change
- Can add colour and notes



3. Photographic Storyboard

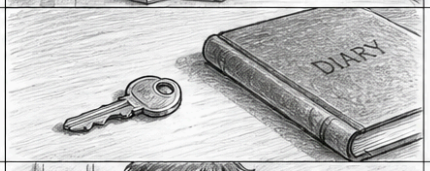
- Uses photos instead of drawings
- Useful for live-action videos

Steps to Create a Storyboard

1. Read the script carefully
2. Divide story into scenes
3. Decide actions in each shot
4. Draw rough frames
5. Add camera angles and movement
6. Write dialogue or sound notes
7. Mention shot duration
8. Add transitions
9. Review and improve storyboard

Example: ShortFilm

Project Title: The Lost Key Scene No.: 3 Page No.: 1 of 2

Shot No.	Visual / Sketch	Camera Angle & Movement	Action / Description	Dialogue / Sound	Duration	Transition
1.		WIDE SHOT Static Shot	Boy wakes up in the morning. Sunlight comes through the window.	Birds chirping soft morning music	4 sec	CUT
2.		MEDIUM SHOT Slight Pan Right	Boy looks for something on the table.	Soft suspense background music	3 sec	CUT
3.		CLOSE UP SHOT Static Shot	Close-up of the key on the table.	Soft sound effect (key glint)	2 sec	CUT
4.		MEDIUM CLOSE UP Slight Zoom In	Boy is surprised to see the key.	Wow ! (Surprised) Light music	3 sec	CUT
5.		WIDE SHOT Static Shot	Boy goes to the door with the key.	Footsteps Door creaks	4 sec	DISSOLVE

Advantages of Storyboard

- Clear visual plan
- Saves editing time
- Reduces mistakes
- Better teamwork
- Helps control budget
- Useful for complex scenes
- Makes story clear

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3. Various Cuts in Video Editing

A cut is the most common transition in video editing. It means one shot ends and the next shot starts immediately. Cuts help control speed, emotion, continuity, and story flow. Editors use different cuts based on the scene and mood.

Various cuts in video editing are:

1. Jump cut
2. Straight cut
3. Match cut
4. Dissolve
5. Cutaways
6. Split Edits (L-Cuts and J-Cuts)

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1. Straight Cut

A straight cut is a direct change from one shot to another shot.

Uses

- Conversations
- Action scenes
- Scene continuation
- Reaction shots

Example:

The person speaking → next shot listener reacts.

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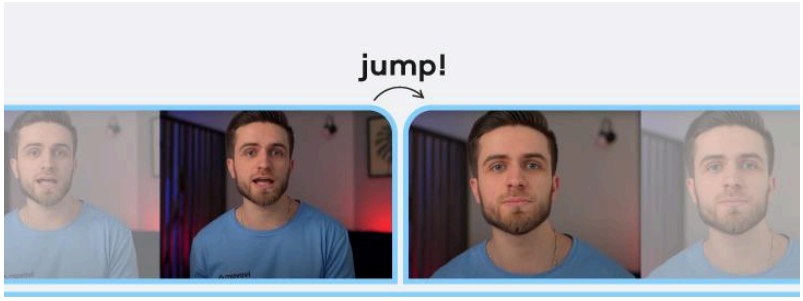
2. Jump Cut

A jump cut shows the same subject with sudden change in position or time. It looks like the subject jumps.

Uses

- Show time passing quickly
- Remove boring parts
- Create fast energy
- Used in vlogs and music videos



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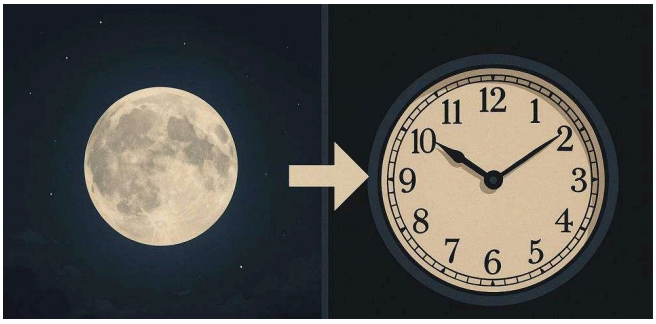
3. Match Cut

A match cut joins two shots using similar action, movement, or shape.

Uses

- Smooth scene changes
- Maintain continuity
- Creative visual effect



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4. Cutaway

A cutaway moves from main action to another related shot, then returns back.

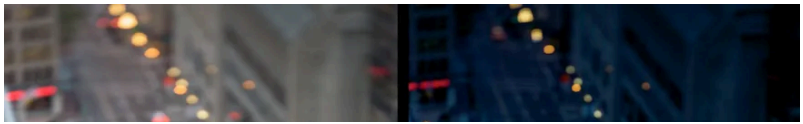
Uses

- Show important details
- Hide editing cuts
- Add extra information

Example:

Talking person → audience clapping.

5. Dissolve



One shot slowly fades into the next shot.

Uses

- Show passage of time
- Soft scene change
- Dream or memory scenes

Example:

The day scene slowly changes to night scene.

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6. Split Edits (L-Cut and J-Cut)

Split edits are audio-based cuts.

1. **L-Cut -** Audio from the first scene continues into the next scene.
2. **J-Cut -** Audio of the next scene starts before the next video appears.

Uses

- Smooth transitions
- Natural conversations
- Professional flow